

# SJAA Ephemeris Bulletin



Oct 2025

## Community

What's the best part about being in an astronomy club? Is it the access to dark sky sites? Access to equipment? In my opinion, the best part is the access to *people*. Not just any people. People who are passionate about the cosmos, and who are eager to share that passion.

We are lucky to count many such people among our membership in SJAA. These people share the views through their equipment. They answer questions about what type of filters to get for your imaging rig. They show you how to polar align your scope at a star party. They hook you up with a 3D printed adapter for your new Seestar. There's a wealth of knowledge and skill to tap into at SJAA.

This is why many people join the club, and I am pleased to report that we are taking more steps to build our community and connect our members. One such step is the Discord server we launched last month. This chat application connects members to each other in a fun and accessible way. Check your email for instructions and join the community conversation. Don't miss out on the most valuable resource your membership has to offer - the people! Oh, and keep looking up.

**Carl Svensson**  
Vice-President  
Ephemeris Editor

## Target of the Month: Double Cluster

The Double Cluster consists of the open star clusters NGC 869 and NGC 884 (also designated  $\kappa$  Persei and  $\chi$  (chi) Persei, respectively), which are close together and visible to the naked eye from dark skies. The star clusters are located 7500 light years away.

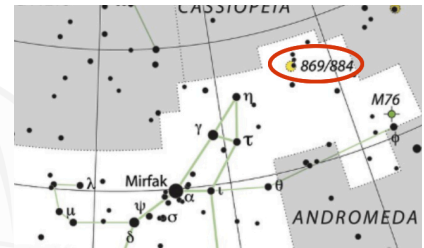
These star clusters have been known since ancient times. The Greek astronomer Hipparchus cataloged the objects as early as 130 BCE. The Double Cluster rates among the most impressive deep-sky objects not to be included in the Messier catalog. Charles Messier was looking for deep-sky objects that could be mistaken for comets. He probably thought nobody would see this pair of star clusters as a comet so he didn't include it in his catalog.

The Double Cluster is a circumpolar object, meaning it never sets for observers in the Northern Hemisphere. The best time to view the clusters is on Autumn evenings. If you zoom in on them with binoculars or a wide view telescope, you'll see them as two superb star clusters. Also, they're an easy target through a telescope and will wow your friends!

To locate the Double Cluster, find the W- or M-shaped constellation Cassiopeia the Queen. If your sky is dark enough, you will be able to see the K-shaped pattern of Perseus the Hero nearby. Then scan between them with binoculars to find the Double Cluster.

*Top: Double Cluster location. Image: IAU and Sky & Telescope magazine (Roger Sinnott & Rick Fienberg) Bottom: Double Cluster by Joe Fragola on 9-20-2025 from West Yellowstone, MT; 8 minutes using a ZWO Seestar S50 and no filters.*

|               |                  |
|---------------|------------------|
| Magnitude     | 3.7, 3.8         |
| Size          | 33ly             |
| Object Type   | Open Clusters    |
| Constellation | Perseus          |
| Distance      | 7500 ly          |
| Age           | 14 million years |



## Announcements

**Member Show and Tell** Come and share something you find interesting, useful, unique, clever, or just amusing. Our October meeting on Saturday the 4th (7:30 pm) will be an opportunity for you to share your unique telescope or binocular builds, tell the story of your favorite astro-photos, pass on image processing tips, or brief astro-travelogues. This is a traditional activity that we haven't done in a long time and so we're going to take this opportunity to bring it back. You are encouraged to attend whether you have something to share or are just interested in what your fellow association members have got up their sleeves.

If you do want to share something we encourage you to fill out the following form, so we can plan: <https://forms.gle/dTAQig9toK1KXvHs6>. But if you forget, or think of something on the day of the event, please go ahead and bring your object/image/story and we'll try to work in last minute additions.

**New Renewal System** Some of you may have noticed that we have changed how new members sign up, and how returning members renew their memberships. This system provides us with better automation and record keeping, which helps us provide robust and timely services for our members. If you have any questions or face any issues, please reach out to us at [asks-jaa@sjaa.net](mailto:asks-jaa@sjaa.net). As always, you can reach our renewal and sign up system through the website at <https://www.sjaa.net/join-the-sjaa/>.

**We Always Need More Volunteers** There are many volunteer opportunities in SJAA! While we love having seasoned experts in our volunteer ranks, we happily welcome enthusiastic beginners, too. Opportunities range from operating telescopes, to authoring content for publication, to helping with event logistics. Please reach out to us at [volunteer@sjaa.net](mailto:volunteer@sjaa.net) to get started!



# SJAA Oct 2025

| Sunday                                                                                                                                                                                              | Monday                                                                                                                         | Tuesday                                                                                                                                                                         | Wednesday                                                                                                                                                                                           | Thursday                                                                                                                                              | Friday                                                                                                                                      | Saturday                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>1</b><br>Pluto 0.05° N of Moon<br><br>71%                                                                       | <b>2</b><br>Ceres at Opposition<br><br>81%                         | <b>3</b><br>Astro 101 7:00PM<br><br>89%                  | <b>4</b><br>Show and Tell 8:00 PM<br>Board Meeting 6:00PM<br><br>95% |
| <b>5</b><br>Solar, Loaner, Fixit 2:00 PM<br>Saturn 4° S of Moon<br><br>Neil deGrasse Tyson's Birthday (1958)<br>95% | <b>6</b><br><br>99%                           | <b>7</b><br>Astro 101 Beginners' Forum 7:00PM<br><br>Donald Machholz's Birthday (1952)<br>100% | <b>8</b><br><br>98%                                                                                                | <b>9</b><br>Moon 0.9° N of the Pleiades (Messier 45)<br><br>93%    | <b>10</b><br><br>85%                                     | <b>11</b><br>Starry Nights 7:30PM<br><br>75%                         |
| <b>12</b><br><br>64%                                                                                                | <b>13</b><br>Jupiter 4° S of Moon<br><br>52%  | <b>14</b><br>Imaging SIG 7:30PM<br>Moon 1.9° N of M44<br><br>41%                               | <b>15</b><br>C/2025 R2 (SWAN) Brightens<br><br>Asaph Hall's Birthday (1829)<br>30%                                 | <b>16</b><br>Regulus 1.2° S of Moon<br><br>21%                     | <b>17</b><br>ITSP 7:30 PM<br>Astro 101 6:15PM<br><br>13% | <b>18</b><br>Member Observing (Mendoza) 6:00PM<br><br>7%             |
| <b>19</b><br>Venus 4° N of Moon<br>Subrahmanyan Chandrasekhar's Birthday (1910)<br><br>3%                         | <b>20</b><br>Mercury 2° S of Mars<br><br>1% | <b>21</b><br>Peak of Orionids<br><br>0%                                                      | <b>22</b><br>Karl Jansky's Birthday (1905)<br><br>2%                                                             | <b>23</b><br>Mercury 2° N of Moon<br>Mars 5° N of Moon<br><br>5% | <b>24</b><br>Antares 0.5° N of Moon<br><br>10%         | <b>25</b><br>Henry Norris Russell's Birthday (1877)<br><br>17%     |
| <b>26</b><br><br>25%                                                                                              | <b>27</b><br><br>34%                        | <b>28</b><br><br>44%                                                                         | <b>29</b><br>Pluto 0.1° S of Moon<br><br>55%                                                                     | <b>30</b><br><br>65%                                             | <b>31</b><br><br>75%                                   |                                                                                                                                                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 | Times and dates are subject to change. Please check <a href="http://sjaa.net">sjaa.net</a> and <a href="http://www.meetup.com/sj-astronomy">www.meetup.com/sj-astronomy</a> for the latest updates. |                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                             | <br>Meteor Shower                                                  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                             | <br>Dark Sky Window                                                |